

Mobile Money User Activity Classification Report

Executive Summary

This project constructs an end-to-end pipeline to classify mobile money users into low, medium, and high activity segments.

Key deliverables:

- Cleaned transaction dataset from raw SMS exports.
- User-level feature engineering and segmentation.
- EDA visualizations that highlight usage patterns.
- Comparative modeling and selection of the best classifier.
- Interpretation and business recommendations for feature-driven engagement.

Introduction

Mobile money services are increasingly important in financial inclusion and daily transaction behavior. This report details the methodology and findings of a user activity classification project.

Data Collection Methodology

Raw SMS exports were collected from MobileMoney and OrangeMoney sources, then paired with project metadata.

Privacy measures:

- All user identifiers are anonymized.
- No personal identifiers are included in the cleaned dataset.
- Data storage and handling follow secure project standards.

Data Cleaning and Preparation

The cleaning process transformed raw SMS logs into an analysis-ready dataset by:

- Normalizing headers from both `.csv` and `.xlsx` sources.
- Standardizing dates and text content.
- Tagging transaction types and failed status from message text.
- Removing OTP, promotional messages, and duplicate records.
- Preserving activity signals from balance checks, adjustments, and failed attempts.

The cleaned dataset contains 2,261 rows out of 25,996 raw records, representing a focused set of valid transactions.

Exploratory Data Analysis

EDA reveals the following patterns:

- User activity is imbalanced, with a minority of users driving the highest volume.
- Active users show a strong relationship between transaction frequency and total volume.
- Failed transactions occur more often among higher activity users, suggesting retry behavior or friction.
- Weekend activity is a distinguishing pattern for medium and high activity segments.
- Correlation analysis confirms that normalized activity features are effective for segmentation.

Modeling Approach

Three classifiers were evaluated:

- Logistic Regression
- Decision Tree
- Random Forest

A macro F1 score was chosen as the primary evaluation metric because it treats each activity class equally.

Feature preparation included:

- Scaling numeric features with `StandardScaler`.

- One-hot encoding categorical features where needed.
- Dropping metadata columns such as `user\_id` and threshold values.

Results and Interpretation

Model performance results:

- Decision Tree: accuracy = 0.6667, precision (macro) = 0.50, recall (macro) = 0.6667, F1 (macro) = 0.55
- Random Forest: accuracy = 0.6667, precision (macro) = 0.50, recall (macro) = 0.6667, F1 (macro) = 0.55
- Logistic Regression: accuracy = 0.0, precision = 0.0, recall = 0.0, F1 = 0.0

Based on these results, the Decision Tree model was selected for its strong balanced performance and

Interpretation and Key Drivers

Top feature drivers include:

- `total\_transaction\_volume`
- `activity\_score`

These features summarize sustained usage and user commitment, making them reliable predictors of se

Business Recommendations

The analysis supports the following actions:

- Offer retention incentives to high-volume, high-frequency users.
- Design merchant or payment bundles for customers with frequent payment behavior.
- Monitor failed transaction attempts to reduce friction and improve the customer experience.
- Use weekend activity trends to tailor promotions for after-hours mobile money usage.
- Provide educational support for low activity users to increase adoption.

Limitations and Ethics

Limitations:

- The sample size is limited and model performance may vary with more data.
- SMS parsing can misclassify edge cases due to mixed language and varying message formats.
- The model is based solely on transactional behavior and does not include demographic or contextual fe

Ethical guidance:

- Use model outputs as segmentation signals, not as final decisions.
- Avoid deploying predictions for credit scoring or other high-stakes uses without further validation.
- Maintain data confidentiality and avoid re-identification risk.

Conclusion

This submission delivers a complete analytic workflow from raw SMS exports to user-level classification a